

THE CRIMSON DAWN

RENEGADE ADEPTUS ASTARTES - FLEET-BASED - RECORDS SEALED

CHAPTER DATA

FORMER DESIGNATION	The Umbral Wardens
PRESENT STATUS	Renegade; officially missing / sealed-file
ALLEGIANCE	Independent creed - neither Throne nor Ruin
GENE-SEED	Unknown (Imperial theories conflict wildly)
COMMAND	Dawnlord Dolor
FLAGSHIP	Ortus Cruentus ("Bloody Dawn")
BATTLE-CRY	"Pain teaches. Dawn follows."
LIVERY	Charcoal-black armour, crimson accents, white-edged red cloud heraldry, dark gunmetal weapons and red eye lenses. Squad leaders bear individualized markings; basing is scorched rock.

ORIGIN

Once a quiet-war brotherhood tasked with sealed archives and suppression work, the Umbral Wardens breached a Mechanicus quarantine vault on Mars and recovered a Terran archaeotech data-casket later classed as memetic contraband. Librarius reconstruction produced a fragmentary pre-Imperial parable of outcast cadres who sought peace through shared suffering and decisive force. Senior command accepted the reading as recovered doctrine. When Mars ordered the casket destroyed, the Chapter refused, fled Sol custody, and struck the Aquila.

THE INCOMPLETE SCRIPTURE

What survives of the casket is badly truncated and biased toward the outcast cadre. Opposing voices are absent or scrambled. The remaining verses culminate in the annihilation of a fortified settlement - and then stop. There is no restoration, no counter-argument, no aftermath. The Dawn read that silence as proof: ruin is the completed lesson. They hunt further fragments believing the Throne hid the rest.

CREED

- Peace bought by ignorance is a lie
- Shared pain ends cycles of war
- Institutions that farm conflict must break
- Settlement-ruin is proof, not tragedy
- The Emperor is rejected as living god
- Skulls honour cost; eagles mark false order

IMPERIAL STANDING

- Public rolls: missing / records sealed
- Mechanicus: quiet recovery or burn order
- Inquisition: need-to-know black warrants
- No open crusade branding
- Most citizens never hear the name
- Hunters know; sermons do not

STRUCTURE & WARFARE

Codex companies give way to a cell network: Dawnlord above, Ring-Bearers as named lieutenants, Cloud Cells as independent kill-cadres. Preferred method - sudden appearance, local overwhelm, symbolic destruction of Imperial command icons, withdrawal before a crusade can consolidate. They leave parables of pain, not occupations.

"The casket never should have been opened. It never should have survived. It did both."